



PROGRESS REPORT

Guinea-Bissau: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 25 systems and instruments tracked

Of 25 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 9 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 13 did not, 2 carry no stated baseline, and 1 is **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 28 sources for this place in the window — 5 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 23 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Guinea-Bissau's most significant movement in this period was legislative and institutional: the transitional parliament enacted a "Digital Integrity" law against online falsehoods, the Council of Ministers approved a revised Electronic Communications Law and, on the same day in July 2025, decrees for a National Data Governance and Protection Policy, a National Cybersecurity Strategy and an interoperability regulation. Of those three, only the interoperability regulation has since moved: [the government approved it as a national framework in August 2026](#), still without a gazetted text on file. Identity infrastructure advanced within an already-Implemented baseline: the ECOWAS biometric card (ENBIC) saw its first field issuance, and Semlex's biometric-ID production network grew to 18 centres. The WARDIP-GB national fibre backbone advanced from a bare programme launch to a [published 2,877 km design and safeguards study](#), still short of construction. Three systems entered the record for the first time with no prior baseline: Guinea-Bissau's first fully digital census (RGPH4), a UEMOA e-money accounts measure, and the STARTOCODE skills programme. Thirteen positions were unchanged across the window, including Guinea-Bissau's sole submarine-cable landing, its Starlink service, and all three tracked finance instruments — a [US\\$60.5m World Bank grant](#), a [US\\$25.4m MIGA guarantee](#) and a [US\\$3.36m UNDP grant](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Digital Transformation Strategy 2025-2030 (ENTD.GW)	Launched Jan 2025 (10 pillars, 55 interventions, roadmap to 2030); Council of Ministers approval/decree still pending	Unchanged - Council of Ministers approval/decree still pending; no further movement on file	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital Integrity (Dissemination of False Information on the Internet) Law	Did not exist	Enacted 21 May 2026 (CNT unanimous passage, with amendments); publication/in-force date and enforcement mechanisms unconfirmed; first invoked by the Ministry of Communication on 21 Jul 2026 over a false TikTok-shutdown claim	ADVANCED
Electronic Communications Law (revised)	Did not exist - the 2010 Electronic Communications regime remained nominally in force	Council of Ministers approved a revised bill, with amendments; not yet confirmed passed by the CNT or in force	ADVANCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Data Governance and Protection Policy (decree)	Draft decree approved by Council of Ministers 2025-07-10; not confirmed published or in force	Unchanged; no further movement on file	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AUDA-NEPAD Programme for African Developing Island Economies (Guinea-Bissau participation)	Did not exist	Ministerial communique adopted 24 Jul 2026 committing Guinea-Bissau to the Programme's 2026-2031 roadmap; no country-level implementation reported yet	ADVANCED

Guinea-Bissau enacted its first digital-specific law in this period: the transitional parliament's "Digital Integrity" law against the dissemination of false information online, which did not exist at the window's start and was passed unanimously with amendments in May 2026. A revised Electronic Communications Law also advanced from nothing to Council of Ministers approval with amendments, replacing the outdated 2010 regime, though not yet confirmed passed by the transitional parliament. The National Data Governance and Protection Policy, the National Cybersecurity Strategy and the commitment to create a National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency were all already at decree-approval or commitment stage at the window's start and remain unchanged, none confirmed gazetted or established. The National Digital Transformation Strategy (ENTD.GW), launched in January 2025, is likewise unchanged, its Council of Ministers approval still pending. Guinea-Bissau's participation in AUDA-NEPAD's Programme for African Developing Island Economies entered the record for the first time in July 2026, with no country-level implementation reported yet.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
MIGA guarantee - Sonatel/ Orange Bissau S.A. equity investment	Guarantee active, in force; US\$0 disbursed (as captured)	Same - no new disbursement or status update found within the window	NO CHANGE
UNDP Mais Digit@l for Guinea-Bissau grant	Active grant; early-stage disbursement of US\$566,152 of US\$3,360,500 recorded	Same - no newer disbursement figure held within the window	NO CHANGE
World Bank WARDIP-GB (DTfA/WARDIP SOP1) IDA grant	Implementation under way following the April 2025 launch; national fibre-backbone design (2,877 km, 56 nodes) published, private-sector wholesale-telecom partner not yet selected	Same - no new status-fixing milestone found within the window; backbone procurement stage unchanged as far as the base holds	NO CHANGE

All three tracked finance instruments were unchanged across the window: the MIGA guarantee behind Sonatel's Orange Bissau equity investment remains active with no new disbursement reported; the UNDP grant funding ENT.D.GW's implementation [still shows only its early US\\$566,152 disbursement against a US\\$3,360,500 commitment](#); and the World Bank's WARDIP-GB IDA grant remains in implementation with no new status-fixing milestone found in this period.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
WARDIP-GB National Fibre-Optic Backbone	WARDIP programme launched (five components); no fixed backbone design published yet; Guinea-Bissau still lacked a national backbone and was seeking deployment experience from Chad (Aug 2025)	2,877 km design specified (56 nodes, 4 phases, >99% population coverage target, private wholesale operator under exclusive licence); EIASS safeguards study published, project moving toward implementation procurement, not yet built	ADVANCED
ACE (Africa Coast to Europe) submarine cable landing	Live since March 2023; sole international connectivity link, national backbone still absent	Unchanged; still the sole international submarine link, WARDIP-GB national backbone not yet operational	NO CHANGE
Starlink satellite internet service	Commercially live since 2025-06-19, Guinea-Bissau's 7th West African / 20th continental Starlink market	Commercially live, unchanged; no newer status update on file	NO CHANGE

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency	Announced and committed to (Jan 2025); not yet established	Still at commitment stage; no source confirms the Agency has been formally established or made operational	NO CHANGE
National Cybersecurity Strategy (decree)	Draft decree approved by Council of Ministers 2025-07-10; not confirmed published or in force	Unchanged; no further movement on file	NO CHANGE

The WARDIP-GB national fibre backbone advanced from a bare five-component programme launch, with no fixed design and Guinea-Bissau still seeking deployment lessons from Chad, to a [published 2,877 km/56-node design and an environmental and social safeguards study](#) – still short of construction. Guinea-Bissau's sole submarine-cable landing (ACE) and its Starlink satellite service were both unchanged across the window, having entered service before it opened.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Interoperability Regulation (public/private digital systems and platforms)	Council of Ministers approval of the draft decree (2025-07-10); no later update on promulgation or publication found	Approved by the government as a national interoperability framework, presented as Guinea-Bissau's contribution to WARDIP; the announcing record names no decree number, gazettal or entry-into-force date	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ENBIC (ECOWAS biometric ID) - Guinea-Bissau deployment	Operationalized nationally (Guinea-Bissau one of six ECOWAS states to fully operationalize ENBIC); no field-level distribution reported (2025-06)	Operationalized, plus a first reported field-issuance pilot - 262 ENBIC cards issued to women cross-border traders in Sao Domingos, March 2026, under a Guinea-Bissau-Senegal mobility project	ADVANCED
Semlex biometric national-ID production network	Functional biometric national-ID card system in place nationally; decentralisation network not itemised (2025-06)	18 production centres nationwide, including the newly opened Safim centre (Biombo, 100 cards/day, third in Biombo); further centres planned for Sao Domingos and Bolama (Bijagos) (2026-02)	ADVANCED

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Electronic-money active accounts (UEMOA/BCEAO reporting)	Not held in the base	Active e-money accounts up 33.28% in 2024; Guinea-Bissau holds 1.94% of UEMOA accounts opened, about 0.7%/1% of regional transaction volume/value, via 2 e-money issuing initiatives nationally (of 69 across the union)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Electoral register update and card replacement	Did not exist	The updated electoral register handed to the elections commission in both physical and electronic form, recording 966,152 registered voters, unchanged from the last update, alongside 25,146 replacement voter cards issued in a 30-day nationwide operation from 13 July to 11 August 2026 by 51 brigades covering every region	ADVANCED
Birth-registration rate (under-fives)	About 46% of under-fives registered (last measured 2025-06)	Same - no fresher measurement found; overall birth registration remains below 50%	NO CHANGE
SIREC (Integrated System of Citizen Registers and Statistics)	Rollout under way since approximately March 2025 (Bissau-first); birth registration around 46% of under-fives, still below 50% overall	Same as start - no fresher status update found; birth registration still cited at 46% (last measured 2025-06), no dated confirmation of regional extension	NO CHANGE
UNDP Building National ID project (civil-registry books scanning and digitization)	Digitization centre established; software development to scan and recover paper registry books under way (2024, year-precision baseline)	Same - no dated update found since 2024	NO CHANGE

Identity infrastructure advanced within an already-operational baseline rather than from nothing: the ECOWAS biometric card (ENBIC), already operationalised nationally at the window's start, saw its first reported field issuance – 262 cards to women cross-border traders in São Domingos – and Semlex's biometric-ID production network grew from an unitemised national footprint to 18 named centres. The interoperability regulation moved at the very end of the window, [approved by the government as a national framework in August 2026](#) after standing a year as an unpromulgated draft decree. SIREC's registry-digitisation pilot, the UNDP civil-registry-books project and the birth-registration rate ([still around 46% of under-fives](#)) were unchanged across the window. Two systems entered the record with no prior baseline: Guinea-Bissau's first fully digital census, RGPH4, which [put the population at 2,191,202 in July 2026](#), and a UEMOA e-money accounts measure showing [Guinea-Bissau's active accounts up 33.28% in 2024 but only 1.94% of the union's accounts opened](#).

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
STARTOCODE digital-skills programme (Telecel + Government)	Did not exist	Coordination committee stood up to supervise annual training of 1,000 youth over four years in programming, data analysis and cloud computing, with emphasis on women and people with disabilities	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration rate	32.5% internet penetration (Jan 2025)	32.5% internet penetration - no fresher measurement held within the window	NO CHANGE

Internet penetration was unchanged across the window at [32.5%](#), [the last measurement held \(January 2025\)](#), with no fresher survey on file. STARTOCODE, the Telecel-government digital-skills programme, entered the record for the first time: its coordination committee was formalised by joint decree in May 2026, [targeting 1,000 youth trained annually over four years](#).

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
RGPH4 (4th General Population and Housing Census)	Not held in the base	Preliminary results released 2026-07-23 - population 2,191,202, 50.7% women, 45.7% urban, 304,939 households, 559,303 dwellings; leaves a digital-cartography and technology base for future operations; full tabulations pending	BASELINE NOT HELD

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report (Apr 2025)	The RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report itself, which would date and confirm the backbone design specifics (2,877 km, 56 nodes) currently resting on an undated project-website primary.	not yet probed

The one absence carried through this period is the RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report, which would confirm the backbone's design specifics. It was not probed in this pass.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.